UI/UX HEURISTIC OBSERVATION FORM

Structured System Usability Assessment Framework

EVALUATOR NAME / ID
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SYSTEM / APP NAME
e.g., CSITE Graduate School Portal

DATE OF ASSESSMENT
10/03/2026

ASSESSMENT MODE
☐ Expert Observation ☑ Client Self-Assessment

1. Target Reach & Touchability

Fitts's Law

CRITERIA	1 - POOR	3 - MODERATE	5 - EXCELLENT	SCORE (1-5)
1.1 Action Size	Buttons or links are tiny (<32px) or difficult to hit without misclicking.	Buttons are adequately sized (32-44px), but feel slightly cramped on smaller screens.	Primary buttons and key controls are large (≥44px), prominent, and effortless to select.	**5**
1.2 Action Placement	Related controls (e.g., input field and submit button) are placed far apart on screen.	Controls are reasonably positioned, but require unnecessary cursor/thumb movement.	Next-step actions are placed immediately adjacent to where the user's attention already is.	**5**
1.3 Screen Anchoring	Key actions are floating in hard-to-reach middle/upper screen areas.	Some key controls are fixed to screen edges/footers, but padding is uneven.	Frequently used actions leverage sticky footers, bottom bars, or screen corners effectively.	**4**

TARGET SCREEN / COMPONENT
e.g., Application Management Table

OBSERVED ISSUE / USABILITY GAP
e.g., Action buttons in the table are small icon-only buttons...

FIX PRIORITY
None

2. Choice & Decision Clarity

Hick's Law

CRITERIA	1 - POOR	3 - MODERATE	5 - EXCELLENT	SCORE (1-5)
2.1 Visual Clutter	Screen is overcrowded with dozens of competing links, buttons, and visual callouts.	Screen is categorized, but still presents more than 6–8 competing options simultaneously.	Clean layout; options are limited to 3–5 primary choices per view to minimize cognitive load.	**5**
2.2 Complex Flows	Long forms or complex multi-step inputs are dumped entirely on a single screen.	Some multi-step flows are divided, but forms still feel long and visually intimidating.	Complex processes are broken into logical, multi-step wizards or collapsible sections.	**4**
2.3 Action Hierarchy	Primary, secondary, and destructive buttons look identical in weight and styling.	The primary action is visible, but secondary options draw nearly equal visual attention.	Clear primary CTA styling with smart defaults provided to guide user choice instantly.	**5**

TARGET SCREEN / COMPONENT

e.g., Coordinator Dashboard

OBSERVED ISSUE / USABILITY GAP

e.g., Too many competing filter dropdowns without a clear reset option...

FIX PRIORITY

None

3. Workflow & Task Efficiency

GOMS Model

CRITERIA	1 - POOR	3 - MODERATE	5 - EXCELLENT	SCORE (1-5)
3.1 Goal Entry Points	Users must guess how to achieve task goals; entry points are hidden in menus.	Goal paths are discoverable, but require brief trial-and-error navigation across screens.	Unambiguous entry points for user goals; task outcomes are clear before starting.	**4**
3.2 Step Optimization	Tasks require excessive clicks, redundant confirmation popups, or screen reloads.	Standard step count required, but lacks shortcuts or batching for frequent tasks.	Minimal steps per task; shortcuts, auto-fill, and batch actions exist for power users.	**4**
3.3 Design Consistency	Similar tasks require completely different UI patterns or steps across screens.	Interaction patterns are mostly consistent, with minor variations in navigation/layouts.	Standardized interaction design across all modules (e.g., consistent search/filter bars).	**4**

TARGET SCREEN / COMPONENT	OBSERVED ISSUE / USABILITY GAP	FIX PRIORITY
e.g., Thesis Application Form	e.g., Requires re-selecting program even when already attached to user account...	None

4. Input Speed & Hesitation

Keystroke-Level Model (KLM)

CRITERIA	1 - POOR	3 - MODERATE	5 - EXCELLENT	SCORE (1-5)
4.1 Data Entry	Forces manual typing for data that could be picked, auto-filled, or selected.	Uses basic form inputs, but auto-complete or smart defaults are rarely used.	Smart defaults, auto-complete, inline error checks, and smart pickers minimize typing.	**4**
4.2 Input Switching	Workflows force constant toggling between typing (keyboard) and pointing (mouse/touch).	Form tab order works, but trigger actions still force switching to mouse/touch.	Full keyboard navigation support (Tab/Enter/Esc) or single-thumb touch flow.	**5**
4.3 Mental Pause	Unclear labels or system delays force users to stop and figure out what to do next.	Minor hesitation occurs due to non-standard iconography or technical jargon.	Clear microcopy, recognized icons, and fast system feedback eliminate hesitation.	**4**

TARGET SCREEN / COMPONENT	OBSERVED ISSUE / USABILITY GAP	FIX PRIORITY
e.g., Panel Member Management	e.g., Tab order skips input fields, forcing user to pick up mouse...	None

5. Visual Organization & Alignment

Gestalt Principles

CRITERIA	1 - POOR	3 - MODERATE	5 - EXCELLENT	SCORE (1-5)
5.1 Grouping & Styling	Unrelated elements are crammed together; related controls use different visual styles.	Related items are grouped, but spacing/styling inconsistencies create minor confusion.	Clear spacing/padding; similar UI components look and behave identically across screens.	**4**
5.2 Containers	Layout lacks visual boundaries or cards, making screens feel chaotic or flat.	Uses cards or borders, but sections feel crowded or visually heavy.	Uses cards, subtle background shades, or dividers to cleanly separate functional areas.	**4**
5.3 Alignment & Grid	Elements feel misaligned; content breaks natural visual scanning patterns.	Layout mostly follows a grid, but minor misalignments fragment visual flow.	Strict grid alignment; eye movement flows naturally across inputs and actions.	**4**

TARGET SCREEN / COMPONENT

e.g., Process Tracker Page

OBSERVED ISSUE / USABILITY GAP

e.g., Step indicators align well, but step detail lists lack clear boundaries...

FIX PRIORITY

None

Assessment Summary & Scorecard

1. Target Reach & Touchability (Fitts's Law)	14 / 15
2. Choice & Decision Clarity (Hick's Law)	14 / 15
3. Workflow & Task Efficiency (GOMS)	12 / 15
4. Input Speed & Hesitation (KLM)	13 / 15
5. Visual Organization (Gestalt)	12 / 15
TOTAL SCORE	**65 / 75 (87%)**

SCORE RANGE	LEVEL	ACTION REQUIRED
60–75 (80-100%)	**Optimized UX**	**Low friction. Minor visual polish.**
45–59 (60-79%)	Moderate Friction	Address targeted usability gaps.
< 45 (< 60%)	High Friction	Priority redesign required.